PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION, WEST BENGAL

CLERKSHIP EXAMINATION, 2023

Part-I (Objective Type) — Question Paper

Advertisement No.	13/2023	**Test Booklet**	Series **A** (Serial No. 1190081)
Session	I	**Date of examination**	16 November 2024 (Saturday)
Time allowed	1 hour 30 minutes (9:30 a.m. – 11:00 a.m.)	**Full marks**	100 (100 questions, 1 mark each)
Subjects	English (30 marks) · General Studies (40 marks) · Arithmetic (30 marks)		

Instructions to candidates (as printed in the official booklet)

1. This booklet consists of 24 pages including the front page, containing 100 questions. Verify the page numbers and the Test Booklet series on each page and bring any discrepancy at once to the notice of the Invigilator.
2. Answers will have to be given in the OMR Sheet supplied for the purpose.
3. Before marking the OMR Sheet, fill in the required particulars. Do not fold the OMR Sheet.
4. All questions are of multiple-choice type. Four probable answers (A), (B), (C) and (D) are given against each question. Choose the correct or the best answer and darken the corresponding circle with a black ball point pen.
5. One and only one circle is to be fully blackened. Multiple circles or a wrong circle will be treated as a wrong answer. Use of whitener is strictly prohibited.
6. There will be negative marking for wrong answers — 0.25 mark for each wrong answer.
7. Blank pages are provided at the end of the booklet for rough work.
8. The OMR Sheet and the Test Booklet must be handed over to the Invigilator before leaving the examination hall.

About this document. This is a faithful English transcription of the official bilingual question booklet released by the Public Service Commission, West Bengal (Test Booklet Series A, Serial No. 1190081). The Bengali column of the official PDF uses embedded legacy fonts and is not reproduced here. The original official PDF is linked from the cover page of this pack — always cross-check with it. The official answer key is in the separate file **2023-answer-keys.html** so that you can attempt the paper honestly first.

Questions 1 – 100

1. Complete the sentence with the correct preposition:

The customs were searching ____ drugs at the airport.

(A) for
(B) on
(C) in
(D) at

2. Insert the correct preposition in the following sentence:

He acceded ____ my request.

(A) for
(B) of
(C) on
(D) to

3. A synonym of the word 'Equivocal' is

(A) Ambiguous
(B) Equal
(C) Clear
(D) Vocal

4. They are men of like build and stature. In this sentence 'like' has been used as a/an

(A) Adjective
(B) Noun
(C) Preposition
(D) Adverb

5. Fill in the blank:

He could not ____ to see his brother in any kind of distress.

(A) bare
(B) beer
(C) bore
(D) bear

6. Which of the responses is correct for the statement?

“I like ice-cream.”

(A) So am I.
(B) So do I.
(C) So I do.
(D) I also like.

7. A ____ of wolves.

(A) herd
(B) colony
(C) drove
(D) pack

8. Study the following sentence: “Come and meet me in my office.”

What part of speech is 'me'?

(A) noun
(B) adverb
(C) pronoun
(D) modal verb

9. The feminine gender of Drone is

(A) Duck
(B) Bee
(C) Filly
(D) Doe

10. Replace the underlined portion with an idiom from the list provided below:

I begged him to reconsider his decision but he refused to yield.

(A) took to his heels
(B) put his foot down
(C) turned his head
(D) took to heart

— Please Turn Over —

11. What is the most appropriate passive form of the following sentence:

The mason is building the wall.

(A) The wall is being built by the mason.
(B) The wall is been build by the mason.
(C) The mason build wall.
(D) The mason is built by the wall.

12. An antonym of the word 'Magnanimous' is

(A) Selfish
(B) Generous
(C) Courageous
(D) Ignoramus

13. He replied that he worked whenever he liked — This is a/an

(A) Simple sentence
(B) Compound sentence
(C) Complex sentence
(D) Exclamatory sentence

14. Replace the underlined verb with the appropriate phrasal verb from those given below:

The building was demolished last year.

(A) pulled down
(B) turned down
(C) gone down
(D) made down

15. Change the following sentence into an Affirmative one:

This story is incomplete.

(A) This story is not incomplete.
(B) This story is complete.
(C) Completeness is there in this story.
(D) This story is totally complete.

16. Replace the underlined verb with the appropriate phrasal verb from those given below:

The plan did not succeed.

(A) come on
(B) come in
(C) come along
(D) come off

17. Change the voice:

The guard refused him admittance.

(A) The guard refused to let him in.
(B) Admission was not granted to him by the guard.
(C) He was not admitted by the guard.
(D) He was refused admittance by the guard.

18. Replace the underlined word with the appropriate idiom from those given below:

He listened when his boss spoke.

(A) heard carefully
(B) paid his ears
(C) gave his ears
(D) was all ears

19. An ophthalmologist deals with

(A) matters of the brain.
(B) diseases related to the respiratory system.
(C) diseases of the eye.
(D) a particular skin disease.

20. Fill in the blanks in the following sentence with the appropriate words:

A man ____ live ____ satisfactorily ____ he does at present ____ half his present income.

(A) could, very, as, by
(B) can, as, as, on
(C) would, as, like, with
(D) will, very, since, by

— Please Turn Over —

21. Replace the underlined portion with an idiom from the list below:

He got himself into trouble by interfering in his neighbour's affairs.

(A) strained every nerve
(B) took to heart
(C) out of spirits
(D) burnt his fingers

22. Fill in the blank with the correct modal verb:

The online store informed that we ____ cancel the order we placed, if we wish.

(A) shall
(B) would
(C) will
(D) can

23. Replace the underlined verb with the appropriate phrasal verb from those given below:

I have stopped smoking.

(A) given in to
(B) given to
(C) given up
(D) given on

24. What kind of a sentence is the following?

The moon was bright and we could see our way.

(A) Complex sentence
(B) Simple sentence
(C) Compound sentence
(D) Exclamatory sentence

25. The adjective form of the word 'Glory' is

(A) Gloried
(B) Glorious
(C) Glorification
(D) Gloriously

26. Choose the correct alternative:

The car broke down and we ____ get a taxi.

(A) have to
(B) had to
(C) must
(D) got to

27. Replace the underlined verb with the appropriate phrasal verb from those given below:

He has quarrelled with her.

(A) fallen in
(B) fallen out
(C) fallen over
(D) fallen down

28. Fill in the blank:

The ____ half of the play was uninteresting.

(A) later
(B) latter
(C) latest
(D) late

29. Change the voice:

All his friends laughed at him.

(A) He was laughed at by all his friends.
(B) His friends laughed at him.
(C) His friends were laughing at him.
(D) He laughed at all his friends.

30. Life is as tedious as a twice-told tale — The figures of speech used in the sentence are:

(A) Metaphor and Alliteration
(B) Apostrophe and Hyperbole
(C) Simile and Alliteration
(D) Alliteration and Personification

— Please Turn Over —

31. 10 men can complete a piece of work in 15 days and 15 women can complete the same work in 12 days. If all the 10 men and 15 women work together, in how many days will the work get completed?

(A) 6 days
(B) 6⅓ days
(C) 6⅔ days
(D) 7⅔ days

32. The ratio between the speeds of two trains is 7 : 8. If the second train runs 400 km in 4 hrs, then the speed of the first train is

(A) 70 km/hr
(B) 75 km/hr
(C) 84 km/hr
(D) 87.5 km/hr

33. Rajaji Raghati Biosphere Reserve is located in which State of India?

(A) Uttarakhand
(B) Himachal Pradesh
(C) Maharashtra
(D) Karnataka

34. The prime numbers dividing 143 and leaving a remainder of 3 in each case are

(A) 2 and 11
(B) 11 and 13
(C) 3 and 7
(D) 5 and 7

35. The greatest number which can divide 1356, 1868 and 2764 leaving the same remainder 12 in each case is

(A) 64
(B) 124
(C) 156
(D) 260

36. Which is the highest peak in Andaman and Nicobar Island?

(A) Mount Koya
(B) Mount Diavolo
(C) Saddle Peak
(D) Mount Thullier

37. At what time between 9 and 10 o'clock will the hands of a watch be together?

(A) 45 min. past 9
(B) 50 min. past 9
(C) 49 1/11 min. past 9
(D) 48 2/11 min. past 9

38. At what rate per cent of simple interest will a sum of money double itself in 12 years?

(A) 8¼%
(B) 8⅓%
(C) 8½%
(D) 9½%

39. A motor car starts with a speed of 70 km/hr with its speed increasing every two hours by 10 km/hr. In how many hours will it cover 345 km?

(A) 2¼ hrs
(B) 4 hrs 5 min
(C) 4½ hrs
(D) None of the above

40. Who founded the University of Nalanda?

(A) Samudragupta
(B) Chandragupta I
(C) Skandagupta
(D) Kumargupta I

— Please Turn Over —

41. In a class, 3/5th of the students are girls and the rest are boys. If 2/9th of the girls and 1/4th of the boys are absent, what part of the total number of students is present?

(A) 17/25
(B) 18/49
(C) 23/30
(D) 23/36

42. Market Control Policy had been first introduced in medieval India by

(A) Iltutmish
(B) Giyas Uddin Balban
(C) Alauddin Khilji
(D) Feroz Shah Tughluq

43. Which is the smallest country in the world, with an area of only 0.49 square kilometre?

(A) Monaco
(B) Vatican
(C) Andorra
(D) Casablanca

44. The HCF of two numbers is 8. Which one of the following can never be their LCM?

(A) 24
(B) 48
(C) 56
(D) 60

45. A shopkeeper has a certain number of eggs of which 5% are found to be broken. He sells 93% of the remainder and still has 266 eggs left. How many eggs did he originally have?

(A) 3800
(B) 4000
(C) 4200
(D) None of the above

46. Which State does not share a border with Myanmar?

(A) Assam
(B) Nagaland
(C) Manipur
(D) Mizoram

47. Which State adopted the Three-tier Panchayati Raj system for the first time?

(A) Rajasthan
(B) Andhra Pradesh
(C) Bihar
(D) Karnataka

48. Which of the following best describes a 'bear market'?

(A) A market in which prices are rising
(B) A market in which prices are falling
(C) A market with stagnant prices
(D) A market with high trading volumes

49. A positive number, which when added to 1000, gives a sum which is greater than when it is multiplied by 1000. This positive number is

(A) 1 **(B)** 3

(C) 5 **(D)** 7

50. Who is considered the founder of Renaissance Art?

(A) Donatello **(B)** Giotto

(C) Masaccio **(D)** Leonardo da Vinci

— Please Turn Over —

51. A sum of ₹ 750 is distributed among A, B, C and D in such a manner that A gets as much as B and C together, B gets ₹ 125 more than C and D gets as much as C. What is A's share?

(A) ₹ 100 **(B)** ₹ 225

(C) ₹ 275 **(D)** ₹ 325

52. The speed of a boat in still water is 10 km/hr. If it can travel 26 km downstream and 14 km upstream in the same time, the speed of the stream is

(A) 2 km/hr **(B)** 2.5 km/hr

(C) 3 km/hr **(D)** 4 km/hr

53. Jamini Roy was a famous ____.

(A) Producer **(B)** Painter

(C) Dancer **(D)** Actor

54. Numismatics is the study of —

(A) Stones and Coins **(B)** Terracotta

(C) Coins **(D)** Inscriptions

55. A group of 1200 persons consisting of captains and soldiers is travelling in a train. If for every 15 soldiers there is one captain, then the number of captains in the group is

(A) 70 **(B)** 75

(C) 80 **(D)** 82

56. A man distributes ₹ 1,65,000 among his daughter, wife and son in such a manner that 1/2 of the daughter's share, 1/4 of the wife's share and 1/5 of the son's share are equal. Find the daughter's share.

(A) ₹ 15,000 **(B)** ₹ 30,000

(C) ₹ 45,000 **(D)** ₹ 60,000

57. The concept of 'Gig Economy' is characterized by

(A) Full-time employment with benefits. **(B)** Short-term contracts or freelance work.

(C) Government jobs. **(D)** Traditional economy.

58. Which State has recently introduced a comprehensive social welfare scheme named 'Yogyasree'?

(A) Bihar **(B)** Jharkhand

(C) West Bengal **(D)** Madhya Pradesh

59. Which institution has released guidelines for livestock telemedicine in India?

(A) AIIMS
(B) National Institution for Telemedicine
(C) NITI Aayog
(D) National Dairy Development Board

60. Who among the following is the winner of Bharat Ratna in 2024?

(A) Karpoori Thakur
(B) A.P.J. Abdul Kalam
(C) Pandit Ravi Shankar
(D) Vikram Sarabhai

— Please Turn Over —

61. The dance form called 'Mohiniyattam' is associated with which State of India?

(A) Kerala
(B) Telangana
(C) Tamil Nadu
(D) Karnataka

62. Which of the following Amendments allows a constitutional status to the Panchayati Raj system?

(A) 71st Amendment
(B) 72nd Amendment
(C) 73rd Amendment
(D) 74th Amendment

63. In a mixture of milk and water, the proportion of water by weight was 75%. If in the 60 gm mixture 15 gm of water was added, what would be the percentage of water?

(A) 75%
(B) 88%
(C) 90%
(D) 80%

64. How much time does sunlight take to reach the Earth?

(A) 8 minutes
(B) 2 minutes
(C) 4 minutes
(D) 16 minutes

65. Recently which Indian shuttler won the title of the Bonn International Tournament?

(A) Aakarshi Kashyap
(B) Ashmita Chaliha
(C) P.V. Sindhu
(D) Tanvi Sharma

66. A man in a train notices that he can count 21 telephone posts in one minute. If they are known to be 50 metres apart, then at what speed is the train travelling?

(A) 55 km/hr
(B) 57 km/hr
(C) 60 km/hr
(D) 63 km/hr

67. The Lonar Lake is located in —

(A) Tamil Nadu
(B) Maharashtra
(C) Uttar Pradesh
(D) Odisha

68. 5/12 of which sum is equal to 3¾ of ₹ 100?

(A) ₹ 750
(B) ₹ 800
(C) ₹ 900
(D) ₹ 1000

69. Which of the following sports is related to the Ezra Cup?

(A) Polo
(B) Tennis
(C) Lawn Tennis
(D) Cricket

70. An article was sold for ₹ 144. If the percentage of profit was numerically equal to the cost price, then find the cost of the article.

(A) ₹ 72 **(B)** ₹ 80

(C) ₹ 90 **(D)** ₹ 100

— Please Turn Over —

71. The 2026 ICC Men's T-20 World Cup will be jointly hosted by

(A) India and Bangladesh **(B)** India and Sri Lanka

(C) India and Pakistan **(D)** Bangladesh and Sri Lanka

72. If in a calendar-year, January starts with Monday, how many Wednesdays do you have in January?

(A) 6 **(B)** 4

(C) 3 **(D)** 5

73. Anasagar Lake is located in which one of the following States?

(A) Gujarat **(B)** Rajasthan

(C) Uttarakhand **(D)** Karnataka

74. The term 'Orographic rainfall' is associated with:

(A) rainfall caused by cyclones. **(B)** rainfall caused by warm air masses.

(C) rainfall caused by mountains. **(D)** rainfall caused by convection currents.

75. Goods and Services Tax Council (GST) of India is headed by

(A) Prime Minister **(B)** Finance Minister

(C) Finance Secretary **(D)** Speaker of Lok Sabha

76. How many Fundamental Duties are mentioned in the Indian Constitution?

(A) Five **(B)** Seven

(C) Nine **(D)** Eleven

77. A and B invest in a business in the ratio 3 : 2. If 5% of the total profit goes to charity and A's share is ₹ 855, the total profit is

(A) ₹ 1,425 **(B)** ₹ 1,500

(C) ₹ 1,573.50 **(D)** ₹ 1,575

78. The average of ten numbers is 7. If each number is multiplied by 12, then the average of the new set of numbers is

(A) 7 **(B)** 19

(C) 82 **(D)** 84

79. What is Argentina's currency?

(A) Dollar **(B)** Kroon

(C) Peso **(D)** Sol

80. Bhitarkanika National Park is located in which State?

(A) West Bengal
(B) Bihar
(C) Odisha
(D) Uttar Pradesh

— Please Turn Over —

81. If a bucket is 60% full, then it contains 4 litres more water than when it is 46⅔% full. What is the capacity of the bucket?

(A) 30 litres
(B) 15 litres
(C) 16⅔ litres
(D) 20 litres

82. Who wrote the book 'Life Divine'?

(A) Swami Vivekananda
(B) Keshab Chandra Sen
(C) Aurobindo Ghosh
(D) Swami Dayananda Saraswati

83. The average of the first nine prime numbers is

(A) 9
(B) 11
(C) 11⅙
(D) 11⅛

84. Who of the following is associated with the musical instrument called Sarangi?

(A) Amjad Ali Khan
(B) V.G. Jog
(C) Buddhadeb Das Gupta
(D) Binda Khan

85. 'National Nursing and Midwifery Commission Bill' is associated with which Union Ministry?

(A) Ministry of Health and Family Welfare
(B) Ministry of Home Affairs
(C) Ministry of Women and Child Development
(D) Ministry of Science and Technology

86. When was FIFA established?

(A) 1900
(B) 1904
(C) 1920
(D) 1930

87. A fan is listed at ₹ 1,500 and a discount of 20% is offered on the list price. What additional discount must be offered to the customer to bring the net price to ₹ 1,104?

(A) 8%
(B) 10%
(C) 12%
(D) 15%

88. 2 men and 7 boys can do a piece of work in 14 days; 3 men and 8 boys can do the same in 11 days. Then 8 men and 6 boys can do three times the amount of this work in

(A) 18 days
(B) 21 days
(C) 24 days
(D) 30 days

89. 'Operation Sarvashakti' recently seen in the news, was launched by which armed force?

(A) Indian Air Force
(B) Indian Navy
(C) Indian Coast Guard
(D) Indian Army

90. Who was the first woman President of the Indian National Congress?

(A) Sarojini Naidu
(B) Annie Besant
(C) Neli Sengupta
(D) Aruna Asaf Ali

— Please Turn Over —

91. The least perfect square number divisible by 3, 4, 5, 6 and 8 is

(A) 900
(B) 1200
(C) 2500
(D) 3600

92. Which country hosted the 'World Environment Day 2024'?

(A) Saudi Arabia
(B) Russia
(C) India
(D) Australia

93. The value of 999 995/999 × 999 is

(A) 990809
(B) 998996
(C) 998999
(D) 999824

94. 1/4 of a tank holds 135 litres of water. What part of the tank is full if it contains 180 litres of water?

(A) 1/6
(B) 1/3
(C) 2/3
(D) 2/5

95. Which one is the important macronutrient for plants?

(A) Nitrogen
(B) Manganese
(C) Copper
(D) Chlorine

96. A number reduced by 35% becomes 325. What percent should it be increased so that it becomes 650?

(A) 25%
(B) 30%
(C) 35%
(D) 45%

97. What is the capital of Nigeria?

(A) Algiers
(B) Abuja
(C) Lagos
(D) Nairobi

98. When one event brings about another event, it is known as:

(A) Correlation
(B) Comparison
(C) Causation
(D) Association

99. Parkachik Glacier is located in which State/U.T.?

(A) Arunachal Pradesh
(B) Ladakh
(C) Jammu and Kashmir
(D) Sikkim

100. Lek is the currency of which country?

(A) Azerbaijan
(B) Angola
(C) Indonesia
(D) Albania

Source. Public Service Commission, West Bengal — Clerkship Examination (Part-I), 2023, Session I, held 16.11.2024. Official booklet: psc.wb.gov.in — ClerkshipS-I.pdf.

Transcription note. Only the English text is given. Where the PDF text layer split a word across a page boundary, the option text was restored from context; no question has been reworded. One question (Q.15, changing a sentence to the affirmative) has a debatable official answer — see the answer-key file.